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Prison, dungeon

3.21.1 Prison, dungeon

References:

Hebrew בַּית, אסר, אָסִיר, אֵסוּר (beyth ’esur, beyth ’asurim, beyth hasurim) JDG 16:21, JDG 16:21, JDG 16:21, JDG 16:25, JDG 16:25, ECC 4:14, JER 37:15

Hebrew בַּית, בּוֹר ((beyth) bor) GEN 40:15, GEN 41:14, EXO 12:29, ISA 24:22, JER 37:16, JER 38:6, JER 38:7, JER 38:9, JER 38:10, JER 38:11, JER 38:13

Hebrew בַּית, כֶּלֶא, כְּלִיא ((beyth) kele’, beyth kelu’) 1KI 22:27, 2KI 17:4, 2KI 25:27, 2KI 25:29, 2CH 18:26, ISA 42:7, ISA 42:22, JER 37:4, JER 37:15, JER 37:18, JER 52:31, JER 52:33

Hebrew בַּית, מִשְׁמָר (beyth mishmar) GEN 42:19

Hebrew בַּית, פְּקֻדָּה (beyth pqudoth) JER 52:11

Hebrew בַּית, סֹהַר (beyth sohar) GEN 39:20, GEN 39:20, GEN 39:21, GEN 39:22, GEN 39:22, GEN 39:23, GEN 40:3, GEN 40:3

Aramaic גֹּב (gov) DAN 6:8, DAN 6:13, DAN 6:17, DAN 6:18, DAN 6:20, DAN 6:21, DAN 6:24, DAN 6:24, DAN 6:25, DAN 6:25

Hebrew מַטָּרָה (matarah) NEH 3:25, NEH 12:39, JER 32:2, JER 32:8, JER 32:12, JER 33:1, JER 37:21, JER 37:21, JER 38:6, JER 38:13, JER 38:28, JER 39:14, JER 39:15

Hebrew מַסְגֵּר (masger) PSA 142:8, ISA 24:22, ISA 42:7

Hebrew עֹצֶר (‘otser) ISA 53:8

Greek δεσμωτήριον (desmōtērion) MAT 11:2, ACT 5:21, ACT 5:23, ACT 16:26

Greek εἱρκτή (heirktē) WIS 17:15

Greek λάκκος (lakkos) WIS 10:14, BEL 1:31, BEL 1:32, BEL 1:34, BEL 1:35, BEL 1:36, BEL 1:40, BEL 1:42, 4MA 18:13

Greek τήρησις (tērēsis) ACT 4:3, ACT 5:18

Greek φυλακή (fulakē) MAT 5:25, MAT 14:3, MAT 14:10, MAT 18:30, MAT 25:36, MAT 25:39, MAT 25:43, MAT 25:44, MRK 6:17, MRK 6:27, LUK 3:20, LUK 12:58, LUK 21:12, LUK 22:33, LUK 23:19, LUK 23:25, JHN 3:24, ACT 5:19, ACT 5:22, ACT 5:25, ACT 8:3, ACT 12:4, ACT 12:5, ACT 12:6, ACT 12:17, ACT 16:23, ACT 16:24, ACT 16:27, ACT 16:37, ACT 16:40, ACT 22:4, ACT 26:10, 2CO 6:5, 2CO 11:23, HEB 11:36, 1PE 3:19, REV 2:10, REV 20:7, 4MA 18:11

Description and usage:

Paul and Silas in prison (Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The prison was a place where criminals or other prisoners were confined. There was no standard size or construction for a prison or jail.

Translation:

Practically all languages have terms for a jail or a prison, though in some instances a descriptive phrase is employed, for example, “place where people are tied up” or “place to be chained.” In some languages highly idiomatic expressions are used, such as “place for eating iron” or “room with rats.” The translation should convey the idea that it is a place where a person is restrained against his will.

The Hebrew word *bor*, the Aramaic word *gov*, and the Greek word *lakkos* refer to a hole or depression in the ground. The *bor* into which Jeremiah was lowered in JER 38:0 was probably a cistern (see 3.9 Cistern<REALIA:3.9>). In the rest of the texts listed for these three words, it is not clear if the hole or pit was natural or man-made.